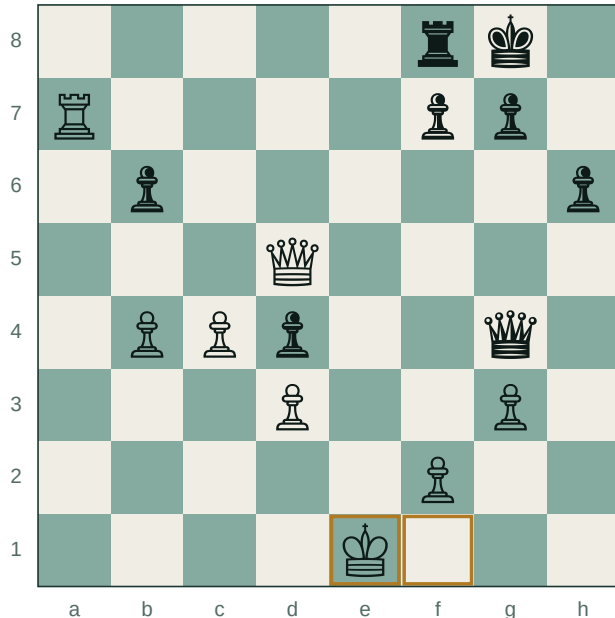


Deflection tactics: Black, move 34

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Kxe1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Re8+ 35. Kf1 Qh3+ 36. Qg2 Re1+ 37. Kxe1 Qxg2

34...Re8+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **35.Kf1**.

35...Qh3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36.Qg2**.

36...Re1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **37.Kxe1**.

37...Qxg2 The queen captures the queen on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a7. Check for tactical protection.